

# Aeolus — Luck Affinity Strings

## Using this handout

- **PL** means Power Level. The **TP / DC** column uses the core PL costs and Thread Check DCs: **1 / 8, 3 / 11, 6 / 14, 10 / 17, 15 / 20**. A successful cast adds that Tension; failure and natural 1 use the core Mishap and Snapback rules. Above her Safe Limit she makes the normal Strain Check; exceeding her Thread Pool is an automatic Snapback. She can choose a lower PL than her maximum.
- **Check attribute:** Each String below shows **CTR**, the default basic Thread Check attribute. Add RB only if the relevant skill is Attuned. If Aeolus expresses a String through a specific Mode, use that Mode's printed check, proficiency, range, techniques, and Weaving rules instead; the label is **not** a permanent Mode assignment.
- On each cast choose **either** the *Favorable* or *Unfavorable* expression in that row, not both. Unless a row says otherwise, one cast affects one visible subject or one reachable mundane object within **30 ft**; a game or social scene requires a participant Aeolus can see or hear. Declare a roll-affecting cast **before the affected die is rolled**. A pending effect expires at the **start of Aeolus's next turn** in combat, or after **1 minute** outside combat, if not used first.
- A listed bonus or penalty changes **one specified nonmagical d20 check or attack roll** only. It cannot affect a Thread Check, Strain Check, saving throw, natural 1/20, already determined result, or a roll with no genuine uncertainty. No creature can benefit from, or suffer, more than **one Aeolus Luck modifier on the same roll**: use the strongest, never the sum. The same declared wager or event cannot be recast to farm attempts.
- Where an *Unfavorable* expression names a **RES save**, the target makes it against that row's DC **when the cast succeeds**. On a success, it avoids the penalty or condition; an effect that specifies half damage still deals half. Damage bonuses require a real hit by a real weapon or another existing source; Luck never creates an attack, an item, a person, a secret, or an impossible path.
- For a **damage-reduction or bonus-damage pool**, roll its listed dice **once when the effect is created**. Subtract the amount used from that total; any unspent amount vanishes when the effect ends. A single-hit reduction rolls its dice when that hit occurs, cannot reduce damage below zero, and cannot be saved for later hits.
- Unless stated otherwise, an ongoing effect requires **concentration** and ends if Aeolus begins concentrating on another String. The Weavekeeper adjudicates whether a plausible chance exists at all. A narrative opening grants only the precise benefit written here, not a guaranteed victory.

## 1. The First Hand String — CTR

**Purpose:** Aeolus's first awakening: a beginner drew one improbably useful hand. Favor an uncertain draw or unsettle someone else's read of it; she still has to know how to play. If a game has **no d20 check**, the Weavekeeper can instead describe a modestly favorable *plausible* draw

for a successful cast; it never specifies a card or guarantees the game's result. This can happen **once per game**, not once per dealt card.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                                      | Unfavorable expression                                                                                                           |
|----|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Gain <b>+1</b> on one check to play a game of chance she is actually taking part in.                                      | A visible opponent takes <b>-1</b> on one check to read or bluff her in that game; <b>RES save</b> negates it.                   |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Gain <b>+2</b> on one game check involving a real draw, deal, or toss.                                                    | One opponent takes <b>-2</b> on one such game check; RES save negates it.                                                        |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Give <b>+2</b> to one willing participant's game check, including Aeolus's, while she observes the same table.            | Up to <b>two</b> visible participants each take <b>-1</b> on their next game check; each gets a RES save.                        |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Give <b>+3</b> to one participant's next game check in a contest with an uncertain outcome.                               | Up to <b>two</b> opponents each take <b>-2</b> on their next game check; each gets a RES save.                                   |
| 5  | 15 / 20 | Give <b>+3</b> to up to <b>three</b> willing players at the same table, for <b>one check each</b> during the next minute. | Up to <b>three</b> opponents at that table each take <b>-3</b> on <b>one check</b> during the next minute; each gets a RES save. |

**Double edge:** She can win a game with Luck; she cannot make winning prove she was the better player.

## 2. The Tell String — CTR

**Purpose:** Notice a tell without learning anyone's thoughts. This is useful in a tavern, an interrogation, or a fight.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                              | Unfavorable expression                                                                                                 |
|----|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | After watching a person for a minute, notice <b>one visible habit</b> relevant to their next action.              | Point out that habit to one ally; they gain <b>+1</b> on one check to notice that person's next <i>physical</i> feint. |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Gain <b>+2</b> on one check to identify a bluff or sleight of hand from someone she can observe.                  | One ally gains <b>+1</b> on their next attack against an opponent Aeolus watched act this round.                       |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Identify which of <b>two visible choices</b> a watched person appears to favor; they can still change their mind. | Up to <b>two</b> allies each gain <b>+1</b> on their next attack against that watched opponent.                        |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Gain <b>+3</b> on one check to detect a watched person's deception; this does not reveal the truth behind it.     | One ally gains <b>+2</b> on their next attack against a watched opponent, before Aeolus's next turn.                   |
| 5  | 15 / 20 | For <b>1 minute</b> of concentration, track the observable tells of up to <b>three</b> people in the scene; each  | Up to <b>three</b> allies each gain <b>+2</b> on <b>one attack</b> against watched opponents before her next turn.     |

|  |  |                                                   |  |
|--|--|---------------------------------------------------|--|
|  |  | of Aeolus's checks to read them gains <b>+2</b> . |  |
|--|--|---------------------------------------------------|--|

**Double edge:** She can read people brilliantly until they begin reading her.

### 3. The Nudge String — CTR

**Purpose:** Tip one small, genuinely uncertain action in someone's favor, without performing it for them.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                             | Unfavorable expression                                                                                 |
|----|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Give herself <b>+1</b> on one nonmagical skill check.                                            | One visible creature takes <b>-1</b> on its next nonmagical skill check; RES save negates it.          |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Give herself or one willing ally <b>+2</b> on one nonmagical skill check.                        | One target takes <b>-2</b> on its next such check; RES save negates it.                                |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Give one willing ally <b>+2</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical skill check.                    | One target takes <b>-2</b> on its next attack roll or nonmagical skill check; RES save negates it.     |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Give one willing ally <b>+3</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical skill check.                    | One target takes <b>-3</b> on its next attack roll or nonmagical skill check; RES save negates it.     |
| 5  | 15 / 20 | Give <b>two</b> willing allies <b>+3</b> each on <b>one different roll</b> before her next turn. | Two visible targets each take <b>-3</b> on <b>one roll</b> before her next turn; each gets a RES save. |

**Double edge:** Nudging a choice is easy. Accepting that another person's success belongs to

them is harder.

## 4. The Slip String — CTR

**Purpose:** Turn a direct blow into a glancing one. She redirects a chance of impact; she does not become untouchable.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                                             | Unfavorable expression                                                                                            |
|----|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Reduce the <b>next hit's damage</b> to herself by <b>1d6</b> before her next turn.                                               | A visible attacker takes <b>-1</b> on its next attack against her; RES save negates it.                           |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Reduce one incoming hit to herself or an ally within <b>10 ft</b> by <b>2d6</b> .                                                | One attacker takes <b>-2</b> on its next attack against a chosen ally within 10 ft; RES save negates it.          |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Reduce one hit to an ally within <b>30 ft</b> by <b>3d6</b> .                                                                    | Two visible attackers each take <b>-1</b> on their next attack against the protected ally; each gets a RES save.  |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Give a single ally within 30 ft a <b>4d6 damage-reduction pool</b> against hits for <b>3 rounds</b> , while Aeolus concentrates. | Two attackers each take <b>-2</b> on one attack against that ally during the next 3 rounds; each gets a RES save. |
| 5  | 15 / 20 | Give up to <b>three</b> allies within 30 ft a <b>shared 6d8 reduction pool</b> for <b>3 rounds</b> , while concentrating;        | Up to three attackers each take <b>-3</b> on their next attack against one of those allies during the next 3      |

|  |  |                               |                               |
|--|--|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
|  |  | spend it only on actual hits. | rounds; each gets a RES save. |
|--|--|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|

**Double edge:** A narrow escape can make her feel invincible right up to the blow that does not miss.

## 5. The Opening String — CTR

**Purpose:** Make a vulnerable instant more likely to matter. The weapon and the attacker do the striking; Luck supplies neither.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                      | Unfavorable expression                                                                                                           |
|----|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | One ally's <b>next successful weapon hit</b> before her next turn gains <b>+1d6 damage</b> .              | One visible opponent takes <b>-1</b> on its next check to keep its footing or hold a position; RES save negates it.              |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | A single next successful weapon hit gains <b>+2d6 damage</b> .                                            | A visible target takes <b>-2</b> on its next such positioning check; RES save negates it.                                        |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | A single next successful weapon hit gains <b>+3d6 damage</b> .                                            | A target takes <b>-2</b> on its next positioning check and loses <b>10 ft of movement</b> on its next turn on a failed RES save. |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Divide a <b>4d6 bonus-damage pool</b> among up to <b>two successful weapon hits</b> before her next turn. | Two visible targets each lose <b>10 ft of movement</b> on their next turn on a failed RES save.                                  |

|   |         |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                 |
|---|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5 | 15 / 20 | Divide a <b>6d6 bonus-damage pool</b> among up to <b>three successful weapon hits</b> before her next turn. | Up to three targets each lose <b>15 ft of movement</b> on their next turn on a failed RES save. |
|---|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**Double edge:** The perfect opening tempts her to claim credit for risks someone else had to take.

## 6. The Misstep String — CTR

**Purpose:** Favor a harmless-looking error in movement: a poor footfall, a mistimed turn, an obstacle almost overlooked. No conjured banana peels.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                             | Unfavorable expression                                                                                                               |
|----|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Gain <b>+1</b> on one check to cross uneven, slippery, or cluttered ground.      | One visible moving creature loses <b>5 ft</b> of its next turn's movement on a failed RES save.                                      |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Give one willing creature <b>+2</b> on such a traversal check.                   | One target loses <b>10 ft</b> of its next turn's movement on a failed RES save.                                                      |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Give two willing creatures <b>+2 each</b> on one traversal check apiece.         | One moving target loses <b>15 ft</b> of movement and falls <b>Prone</b> on a failed RES save, if the terrain makes a fall plausible. |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Give up to three willing creatures <b>+3 each</b> on one traversal check apiece. | Two moving targets each lose <b>15 ft</b> and fall Prone on failed RES saves, where a fall is plausible.                             |

|   |         |                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                            |
|---|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5 | 15 / 20 | For <b>3 rounds</b> , give up to three willing creatures <b>+3 on one traversal check each</b> through the chosen hazardous area, while concentrating. | Up to three moving targets each lose <b>20 ft</b> and fall Prone on failed RES saves, only if their surroundings allow it. |
|---|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**Double edge:** She knows how to exploit a stumble; she might forget that someone else has to live with the fall.

## 7. The Loose Change String — CTR

**Purpose:** Be where a small, already-existing thing can be found or mishandled. This is the tavern scavenger's Luck, not material creation.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                | Unfavorable expression                                                                                             |
|----|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Gain <b>+1</b> on one search check for a mundane object known to be in the immediate area.          | A target handling a <b>loose object</b> takes <b>-1</b> on its next check to keep hold of it; RES save negates it. |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Gain <b>+2</b> on one search check for a mundane object in the current room.                        | A target handling a loose object takes <b>-2</b> on its next check to hold it; RES save negates it.                |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Give <b>+2</b> to up to two people on one search check each for a specific, present mundane object. | On a failed RES save, one target <b>drops one loosely held object</b> at its feet; not a secured or strapped item. |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | Gain <b>+3</b> on one check to find a mundane clue or                                               | On failed RES saves, up to two targets each drop <b>one</b>                                                        |

|   |         |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                       |
|---|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |         | object actually present in a searched area within <b>30 ft.</b>                                                                     | <b>loosely held object</b> at their feet.                                                             |
| 5 | 15 / 20 | For <b>1 minute</b> , grant up to three searchers <b>+3 on one check each</b> to locate a specified, actually present mundane clue. | Up to three targets each drop one loosely held object on failed RES saves; no effect on secured gear. |

**Double edge:** A little thing found at the right time might also be a little thing someone else lost.

## 8. The Fork String — CTR

**Purpose:** Notice which of two real routes has better odds. She cannot cause a safe exit to exist where none does.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                 | Unfavorable expression                                                                                 |
|----|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Get a general sense of which of <b>two visible routes</b> looks less physically hazardous right now. | An observer pursuing her takes <b>-1</b> on one check to follow her chosen route; RES save negates it. |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Gain <b>+2</b> on one check to navigate either of two routes she can inspect.                        | One pursuer takes <b>-2</b> on one check to track her route; RES save negates it.                      |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Guide up to two allies, each gaining <b>+2</b> on one check to traverse the chosen route.            | Two pursuers each take <b>-2</b> on one check to track that route; each gets a RES save.               |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | For <b>1 minute</b> , guide up to three allies;                                                      | Two pursuers each take <b>-3</b> on one                                                                |

|   |         |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                        |
|---|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |         | each gains <b>+3 on one traversal check</b> along a real route she has observed.                                                                         | tracking check along that route; each gets a RES save.                                                 |
| 5 | 15 / 20 | For <b>3 rounds</b> of concentration, guide up to five allies; each gains <b>+3 on one traversal check</b> through a visible, physically passable route. | Up to three pursuers each take <b>-3</b> on one tracking check along that route; each gets a RES save. |

**Double edge:** Knowing the better road does not mean knowing where she wants it to take her.

## 9. The Wager String — CTR

**Purpose:** Accept a declared personal cost for a better chance. She must put something of her own on the table.

**Stake rule:** On a successful cast Aeolus loses the listed VP **immediately**, whether the later roll succeeds or fails; she cannot use Wager if this would reduce her below **1 VP**. The stake is ordinary VP loss, not transferable or refunded by the String. Declare the beneficiary and roll before casting. The *Unfavorable* expression still requires a real opponent and a RES save.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                        | Unfavorable expression                                                                 |
|----|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | Stake <b>1 VP</b> ; Aeolus gains <b>+2</b> on one nonmagical check.         | Stake 1 VP; one opponent takes <b>-2</b> on one nonmagical check on a failed RES save. |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Stake <b>2 VP</b> ; she or an ally gains <b>+3</b> on one nonmagical check. | Stake 2 VP; one opponent takes <b>-3</b> on one nonmagical check on a failed RES save. |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Stake <b>3 VP</b> ; she or                                                  | Stake 3 VP; one                                                                        |

|          |                |                                                                                                      |                                                                                                           |
|----------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|          |                | an ally gains <b>+4</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical check.                                      | opponent takes <b>-4</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical check on a failed RES save.                     |
| <b>4</b> | <b>10 / 17</b> | Stake <b>5 VP</b> ; one ally gains <b>+5</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical check.                 | Stake 5 VP; one opponent takes <b>-5</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical check on a failed RES save.     |
| <b>5</b> | <b>15 / 20</b> | Stake <b>8 VP</b> ; two allies each gain <b>+6</b> on one different attack roll or nonmagical check. | Stake 8 VP; two opponents each take <b>-6</b> on one attack roll or nonmagical check on failed RES saves. |

**Double edge:** Betting on herself feels exhilarating until the cost comes due, win or lose.

## 10. The Second Chance String — CTR

**Purpose:** Give a *different* attempt a chance to succeed after a visible failed attempt. This never rerolls or changes the failure.

| PL       | TP / DC       | Favorable expression                                                                                                                        | Unfavorable expression                                                                                                                       |
|----------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>1 / 8</b>  | After witnessing a failed nonmagical task, Aeolus gains <b>+1 on her own new attempt</b> at it; the situation must still allow another try. | An opponent who just succeeded at a contested nonmagical task takes <b>-1</b> on a <i>new</i> attempt at the same task; RES save negates it. |
| <b>2</b> | <b>3 / 11</b> | Aeolus or an ally gains <b>+2</b> on one permitted new attempt at a                                                                         | One opponent takes <b>-2</b> on a permitted new attempt at a                                                                                 |

|          |                |                                                                                                |                                                                                                                         |
|----------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|          |                | witnessed failed task.                                                                         | witnessed successful task; RES save negates it.                                                                         |
| <b>3</b> | <b>6 / 14</b>  | Up to two allies each gain <b>+2</b> on one permitted new attempt after a witnessed failure.   | Two opponents each take <b>-1</b> on one permitted new attempt after witnessed successes; each gets a RES save.         |
| <b>4</b> | <b>10 / 17</b> | Up to two allies each gain <b>+3</b> on one permitted new attempt after a witnessed failure.   | Two opponents each take <b>-2</b> on one permitted new attempt after witnessed successes; each gets a RES save.         |
| <b>5</b> | <b>15 / 20</b> | Up to three allies each gain <b>+3</b> on one permitted new attempt after a witnessed failure. | Up to three opponents each take <b>-3</b> on one permitted new attempt after witnessed successes; each gets a RES save. |

**Double edge:** Aeolus can make failure less final, but cannot spare anyone the memory of failing.

## 11. The Narrow Escape String — CTR

**Purpose:** Preserve someone from a *survivable* hazard. This bends a fall, a collapsing shelf, or a swing toward a less awful result; it does not undo death.

| PL       | TP / DC      | Favorable expression                             | Unfavorable expression                     |
|----------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>1 / 8</b> | Reduce the next instance of <b>environmental</b> | A visible creature in a real environmental |

|          |                |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                              |
|----------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|          |                | <b>damage</b> to herself by <b>1d6</b> before her next turn.                                                                                 | hazard takes <b>-1</b> on one check to avoid it; RES save negates it.                                        |
| <b>2</b> | <b>3 / 11</b>  | Reduce one environmental hit to herself or an ally within <b>10 ft</b> by <b>2d6</b> .                                                       | One creature in an existing hazard takes <b>-2</b> on one check to avoid it; RES save negates it.            |
| <b>3</b> | <b>6 / 14</b>  | Reduce one environmental hit to an ally within <b>30 ft</b> by <b>3d6</b> .                                                                  | Two creatures in existing hazards each take <b>-2</b> on one avoidance check; each gets a RES save.          |
| <b>4</b> | <b>10 / 17</b> | Reduce one environmental hit to an ally within 30 ft by <b>5d6</b> ; this cannot prevent an effect with no survivable outcome.               | Two creatures in existing hazards each take <b>-3</b> on one avoidance check; each gets a RES save.          |
| <b>5</b> | <b>15 / 20</b> | For <b>3 rounds</b> of concentration, protect up to three allies within 30 ft with a <b>shared 6d8 environmental-damage reduction pool</b> . | Three creatures in real, immediate hazards each take <b>-3</b> on one avoidance check; each gets a RES save. |

**Double edge:** The person who walks away may mistake survival for proof that the risk was harmless.

## 12. The House Edge String — CTR

**Purpose:** Arrange several *small* chances across a room, as if Aeolus has finally learned to see the whole table. No one roll becomes certain.

| PL | TP / DC | Favorable expression                                                                                                               | Unfavorable expression                                                                                                 |
|----|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 1 / 8   | One willing ally within <b>15 ft</b> gains <b>+1</b> on one nonmagical check.                                                      | One opponent within 15 ft takes <b>-1</b> on one such check on a failed RES save.                                      |
| 2  | 3 / 11  | Two allies within <b>20 ft</b> each gain <b>+1</b> on one different nonmagical check.                                              | Two opponents within 20 ft each take <b>-1</b> on one such check on failed RES saves.                                  |
| 3  | 6 / 14  | Three allies within <b>30 ft</b> each gain <b>+1</b> on one different attack roll or nonmagical check.                             | Three opponents within 30 ft each take <b>-1</b> on one different attack roll or nonmagical check on failed RES saves. |
| 4  | 10 / 17 | For <b>3 rounds</b> of concentration, three allies within 30 ft each gain <b>+2 on one attack or nonmagical check total</b> .      | Three opponents within 30 ft each take <b>-2 on one attack or nonmagical check total</b> on failed RES saves.          |
| 5  | 15 / 20 | For <b>3 rounds</b> of concentration, up to five allies within 30 ft each gain <b>+2 on one attack or nonmagical check total</b> . | Up to five opponents within 30 ft each take <b>-2 on one attack or nonmagical check total</b> on failed RES saves.     |

**Double edge:** A crowded room can make everyone feel like part of her game. She still has to see them as people.